

Content overview

This unit requires students to study the nature of Judaism and its effects on the lives of Jewish believers in the UK. There are four sections covering beliefs and values, community and tradition, worship and celebration, and living the Jewish life.

Key words are given at the beginning of each section. Students should be aware of their meanings and be able to use them in their examination answers. A glossary of the key words can be found in *Appendix 4*.

In order to meet Assessment Objective 2, students need to be aware of a range of responses addressing religious and/or non-religious beliefs.

Assessment overview

Assessment will be through a one-and-a-half-hour examination. The examination will be divided into four sections and students will be expected to choose one of the two questions set on each section, ie four questions in total. Each question is sub-divided into four parts structured on an incline of difficulty.

Religious Studies papers are designed to give access to the full range of grades and are not tiered.

Quality of Written Communication will be assessed through Assessment Objective 1 in part c) of each question.

Detailed unit content

Section 12.1 Beliefs and values

Students will be required to: demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specification; express their own responses to the issues and questions raised by the specification using reasons and evidence; evaluate alternative points of view about these issues and questions.

Key words — covenant, Decalogue, halakhah, hashem, Mishnah, omnipresent, shekinah, Shema, Talmud, Tenakh, teshuva, Torah

- The oneness of the Almighty as seen in the Shema.
- The Holiness of the Almighty (Leviticus 19:1, 22:31-33).
- The creation by the Almighty and different attitudes among Jewish people to the accounts in Genesis 1-3.
- The nature of the Almighty as shown in the Ten Commandments.
- The meaning and importance of the Covenant with Abraham.
- The meaning and importance of the Covenant with Moses.
- The nature and importance of the Tenakh.
- The nature and importance of the Torah.
- The importance and use of the Mishnah, Talmud and Responsa.
- The nature and importance of the halakhah.
- Why there are different beliefs about the Messiah among Jewish people.